

Vertigo!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 676 February 2005 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards.



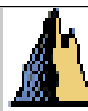
4 April 2005 – AGM and other treats

-The Wgtn section's AGM is a once-a-year opportunity to hear a report on the last 12 months and vote for your favourite committee members! Nigel promises it will be short and sweet....

-Dave Bamford, National Prez will give a brief illustrated presentations in 2004 Alpine Club developments.

-Geoffroy Lamarche will talk on "Undersea Mountains around NZ". Geoffroy is a marine geophysicist for NIWA and he will give an illustrated talk on the submarine mountains, volcanoes, landslides and active faults that have shaped the NZ seafloor.





Section trips news

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

New routes down south

In late January David Morgan and Matthew Woods (Woods as he's known) headed off with big ambitions to the hills around Mt Cook. The weather was looking good for 3 days so we headed up the Hooker glacier. Well that plan ended 9 hours later after wandering on the glacier 3-4 hours trying to find a way through. The 27-degree weather on the Hooker and some pretty big crevasses conspired against us. The route on to pudding rock was nasty, with some big, creaking, dripping seracs threatening it. Always better to be back another day. 12 hours walking from day start saw us back on the playing fields above the Hooker glacier for a lovely bivvy under the watchful eye of the south face of Cook - with a full moon sitting on top (just like the cherry in the ice cream story)!

Next day saw us head out to the village and set sail for the Ohau range with promise of good weather for a few more days. Dawn broke nice and early and we left the car, crossed the river for our leisurely 3 hour walk up to the base of the Tenderfoot wall on Mt Glen Lyon (found by Woods and Paul Hershey a little while back, where they climbed the first route) - took more like 4-5 hours, a bit too much leisure!

With only one route on the wall we had plenty of scope for a new route. The wall is about 400m in height with some laid back sections and some steeper bits. Our route took us up a slab for 3 pitches (not much gear but easy climbing) and onto a ledge, which we soloed up to another wall. There we soloed another 70m or so of a sweet corner before Woods put on the rope for a scary lead. A few more pitches and another superb lead by Woods saw us on another ledge and the route narrowing to a ridge with little promise of a way off. Anyway the problem was surmounted by a chin up on a very precarious block bigger than both of us. Another 200m or so of scrambling took us to the summit of Glen Lyon at about 8pm, beautiful views all round. The 800m of a living scree slope and we were on the valley floor. After attempting a river crossing in the dark we flagged the idea, deciding safety came first and ended bivvying again on the river bed (within view of the car in morning). A cold night sleeping on a dusty riverbed ensued and we were pretty thankful for 5:30am when it was light enough to cross the river. Note to readers - if your mate is happily sleeping (all be it shivering his ass off) don't wake him up to tell him he's cold (thanks Woods!), its pretty hard to get back to sleep again.

We had a leisurely drive back to Omarama for some bacon, eggs and hasbrowns and then a swim in Lake Benmore and some sunbathing. All in all a pretty wholesome and exciting trip for 4 days down south. It should be noted for you guys who have your sights set on big mountains (just like us) there is some really good stuff to be done in the Ohau region. The route is unnamed but we think would be about a grade 4, crux 16ish.

Dave Morgan

J and J in the Landsborough

Johnny Mulheron (NZAC Wgtn) and Jonathan Kennett (Kennett Bros) just got back from a 5-day transalpine trip to Marks Flat. Going up the Paringa River they waited a day for the weather to settle at the fabulous Tunnel Creek rock biv and then took the high route beneath The Buttress and Mt McCullaugh into Murdock Creek and Marks Flat. Having had some battles with crevasses on this route they flagged summiting Mt Hooker and exited out the Solution Range to the Landsborough River. This is wonderfully wild and remote wilderness.

Johnny Mulheron

O'Brien Rodgers Taylor at the Chasm

Three bewildered Wellington climbers (Mike O'Brien, Scott Taylor and Michele Domaneschi) are wandering around Queenstown airport. A trolley full of gear and no meeting point, time or further details. "You vuh lot from vuh alpine club ven?" (Paul Rodgers)

The closer we got to Milford the harder it rained. Homer hut was out of the question with a river in flood, so Milford lodge it was. "Arv spent twelve yers duveloping a crag just fuh whevva like viss".

Whatever.

Sunday morning dawned to tourists and bits of tourists and bits of cars and trees blowing past the large lodge windows. Moods sank. A week of rain was forecast. The wind died (as predicted by our host) but the rain didn't. In the car and off to "The Chasm".

This can't be happening.

A sodden 5 minute walk through the rain forest to the foot of climbs. A wall of granite slabs with a massive overhanging rock brow. Visions of sandflies and climbers crashing out of the sky clobbered by enormous drops of rain. Water sheeted off the brow in a single 200m wide blade, landing right at our feet. Is a grade 16 approach climb still 16 with water running down it? The top of the approach pitch saw sopping rock shoes, cold hands, wet ropes and 4 climbers standing at the foot of a sea of dry granite. A cocked eyebrow. A grin.

Rain all week. 4 finishes after dark, one start before dawn, 2 snow falls. Lots of sends, lots of rescues (for practice) and a lifetime of routes still to be discovered. Yosemite with rain.

Highlights:

Contact Neurosis

Jack the Biscuit

Granite Gringo

Buster Gonad

Proximity Infatuation

Safety In Numbers

On the Prow

Groove Armada

Some first ascents, also other as-yet-unnamed climbs.

Thanks to Paul Rodgers and the Alpine club for making the trip possible.

Michele Domaneschi

Following their week in the Darrens Mike O'Brien and Scott Taylor spent a weekend at Castle Rock in the Port Hills, and attended a pre-assessment for NZOIA Rock Two with Chris Burtenshaw. The weekend went well, and the contribution from the section towards the costs was much appreciated (although taking 12m falls while being belayed by the assessor is not

recommended). The club supports instructors extending their skills. Look out for the new courses the club will be running soon.....***see later in this issue for Autumn Rock***

Mike O'Brien

Pete's Post

People often use human terms to describe the environment - we talk about "Mother Nature" and "angry seas". In reality, the environment is neutral, and we humans must learn how to cope with it in a safe and enjoyable manner. If we understand and appreciate what is occurring around us, we'll have a better chance of surviving, completing our mission, or having an enjoyable day.

I was reminded of this during a recent SAR exercise. There's an old adage, "There's no such thing as extreme cold - only inadequate clothing". My feet were cold in my Scarpa plastic boots, my fingers were hurting, and my cheeks were starting to feel frost nipped. My pack was only a few metres away, but I couldn't easily reach it - I was busy tending the rope at the edge of a big crevasse as the victim (my American friend, Dave) was being hauled out in a stretcher. By now he was genuinely in the early stages of hypothermia, having been in the crevasse for 40 minutes before we even arrived on the scene.

Everything seemed to be taking too long as we prepared the rescue. I was starting to get grumpy with the delays. Dave was complaining about the cold and asking us to just get him out of there. The temperature was minus 25 degrees and there was a chilly breeze. Mother Nature was obviously out to challenge us today.

I turned around to check the ropes, and to give an instruction to the rest of my team. At this point I caught sight of the mountains across McMurdo Sound, which looked far larger, clearer, and closer than normal. A weird mirage effect, called a morgana, extended across the bottom of the mountains, causing them uplift from the surrounding

ice by about an extra third of their height. The mountains glowed orange, due to the low angle of the sun at this time of the year. "This is why you came here", I said to myself as I turned back to continue with the rescue.

After that, things didn't seem nearly so bad. I quickly removed my frozen leather gloves and shoved them into my jacket to warm them up. If I shielded my hands by keeping my back to the breeze, then two layers of liner gloves were sufficient. I pulled the hood of my jacket closer to my face, and it trapped enough of my exhaled breath to keep my cheeks warm. (Well, maybe warm is an exaggeration but the frost nipped sensation stopped.) I stomped my feet to keep the blood circulating to my toes, and quickly ate the Turkish Delight bar that I keep in my jacket pocket.

Within a few seconds my personal attitude to my environment had changed, and my comfort level had improved dramatically.

We were told afterwards that the rescue had proceeded very smoothly, and the instructors were impressed with how quick and effective we had been. The temperature hadn't been particularly cold by Antarctic standards, but there were a few things we could try that might keep our feet a bit warmer. I decided to keep a few extra items in my jacket pocket - especially my neoprene face mask.

For me, the big reminder was not to complain about the conditions, but to concentrate on coping efficiently with them. It's your attitude to your surroundings that seems to make a huge difference.

And I remembered that it's a privilege to be here. I mustn't get so focused on my work that I stop enjoying the view.

Pete de Joux from the Antarctic



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Ph/Fax (04) 4735353 email mainly.tramping@paradise.net.nz



Looking Ahead – Dates for Diaries

Monday, 2 May: Colin Monteath will be the guest speaker at our May section night meeting. He'll be talking and showing slides on his 2004 "Skiing to K2" expedition.

Monday, 13 June: The Wellington section's annual photo-comp. This year there's a new judge -- Paul Clarke, who showed his own first-class photos about climbing Kenya's remotest mountain to the Wellington section in late 2003. Wellington section member, Peter Laurenson, fared outstandingly well in last year's national photo competition, so we're looking forward to seeing lots of good entries in this year's Wellington section photographic competition. Start sorting your slides now.



Banff is Back!

That's right, the Best of Banff Mountain Film Festival World Tour is being brought to Wellington again by the Wellington Section of the New Zealand Alpine Club. In previous years this has been a sell out so get your ticket early!

Date: Sunday May 8

Time: 7.30pm

Cost: \$15

Tickets:

Pre Sales at the April Section night, Monday 4 April from 7.30pm - 8pm

Tickets from the Outdoor Shops: From Tuesday 5 April at:

Bivouac Outdoor
Mainly Tramping
Mountain Designs

Please note ticket sales are cash only...



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AUTUMN ROCK 2005

It's that time of year again – we are running the ever popular annual Rock Course, and are taking names of interested people. This introduction to outdoor rock climbing will run over April and May, and covers climbing technique and all the skills needed to safely set up, belay, climb and abseil. This is a great way to get out to New Zealand's crags and get a bunch of climbing partners to go on missions with!

Wednesday 13 April Indoor Session

Saturday 16 April Titahi Bay (day trip)

Wednesday 20 April Indoor Session

Wednesday 27 April Indoor Session

Sat/Sun 30 April Kinloch Crag (weekend away)

Wednesday 4 May Indoor Session

Sat/Sun 7 May Wharepapa Crags (weekend away)

The course is usually followed by a post course trip to the likes of Paynes Ford, Mangatepopo, Taranaki or ...?! The course is run by volunteer professional instructors, and costs \$320 for members (which covers transport, accommodation, evening meals, gear, venue hire, booklet and instruction).

To find out more and/or book a place on the course, call Scott or Mike on 3800913, or email mob@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz. Places are already filling, so don't delay.....

Interested in Instructing?

We are always interested in hearing from anyone who would like to share their knowledge, experience and skills with others in the club – and gain new skills at the same time. The club supports instructors with training and can give assistance working towards qualifications. Anyone who believes they have something to offer and is interested in helping on rock climbing instruction courses can contact Mike or Scott on 3800913, or email mob@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

Climbers wanted for show

Andre Anderson, the creative producer of "Maui -- The Legend" has contacted the club about the possibility of climbers working on the production. His letter speaks for itself and says:

"Our vision is to create and stage an original New Zealand show that combines Maori performing arts with aerial displays to tell the legends of Maui in an innovative new way. The show is called "Maui -- The Legend" and is scheduled to open on Wednesday 25 May 2005 in the Westpac St James Theatre on Courtenay Place.

"The aerial displays adapt climbing techniques to the theatre. The aim is to realise the considerable theatrical potential in being able to swing performers through the air using ropes and harnesses. Performers wear full-body harnesses and swing out from raised platforms at the side of the stage. Other aerial displays involve counter-balancing, in which performers rise and fall in the air, via off-stage climbers and pulleys.

"Accordingly, to execute the aerial displays safely, we are looking for qualified climbers to supervise the aerial choreography from side-of-stage. The team of 3 or 4 climbers will be led by climbing director, Jamie Ogilvie, from London. In addition to being an experienced climber, Jamie has also had extensive experience working with Argentinean aerial theatre company, De La Guarda, during performance seasons in London, Las Vegas, Seoul, Amsterdam and Berlin.

"We are offering \$500 per week for 9 weeks' work (\$4,500). The contract would begin Monday 4 April with 6 weeks of rehearsals, move into the theatre from Monday 16 May for 9 days of technical and dress rehearsals, followed by the first public performance on Wednesday 25 May. The initial contract would end with the 14th performance on Sunday 5 June (during Queen's Birthday Weekend).

"The job requires the climbers to closely supervise the performers in order to ensure their safety in the air. Climbers are responsible for rigging and maintaining the ropes and attachments, checking the performers' harnesses, ensuring the attachment hardware is properly secured to the harness and then supervising during each piece of aerial choreography. In addition, where counter-balancing is involved, the climber will be in a harness, attached to the other end of the rope used by the performer, and will be responsible for causing the performer to rise and fall in the air. During these aerial displays, a good sense of timing, musicality and artistry is desirable, although these skills can be developed in rehearsal.

"The objective of the Wellington season is to assess the show's potential. If the season is deemed to be a success, then the aim is to tour the show further, with the longer-term goal of taking the show to the West End in London and/or to Broadway in New York City. As it is highly desirable to be able to use the same climbers in the future, for the Wellington season we hope to find climbers that would be interested in the long-term plans for the show.

"If you have any further questions, please email me at <Andre@teaomarama.com> or phone me on (04) 472-9973."



For Sale/Wanted to buy

Personal Locator Beacon

I have an emergency locator beacon. When I am not using it, which is quite a few weekends, it is essentially a useless lump of plastic. If people want to borrow it for their weekend trips, then they can borrow it off me. It is hardly going to depreciate with use. Club members might as well get as much use out of it as possible. I just hope that while people carry it, they don't have to "use" it. Know what I mean?

Anyway, the offer is there. People can contact me on this e-mail address if they want to borrow it.

Sam

Samuel.Newton@nzpost.co.nz

Adjustable 12 point crampons with key in Charlet Moset crampon bag. Good condition. \$140.
Contact Chris on 021 307 353.

Makalu La Sportiva boots, mens size 41 European. Hardly worn though have been snow sealed, in excellent condition. \$200neg,
phone Erin 021 339382 or email erinpentie@yahoo.com



Quiz Number 15

THE ANSWER TO QUIZ NUMBER 15

Oh dear, oh dear... Maybe climbing and culture don't mix after all!

Quiz number 15 asked for the name of the New Zealand soldier who wrote the poem entitled "The Long Way Back" about climbing Mont Blanc after World War II. No one submitted an answer -- even a wrong answer -- to the chairperson by 28 February. The answer was Les Cleveland. The poem is in *The Iron Hand: New Zealand Soldiers' Poems from World War Two*, a book that Les Cleveland edited and was published by the Wai-Te-Ata Press in 1979.



Quiz Number 16

Here's your chance to redeem yourselves, you unpoetic slobs! Our aged chairperson, Nigel Roberts, has taken offence at the following statement: "He was now 65 years of age, an age when most mountaineers have hung up their ice axe and retired to the rocking chair."

Consequently, quiz number 16 is: Who was that statement made about, and who made that statement?

Email your answers to NR@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz by no later than noon on Sunday, 3 April. Be sure to put Quiz Number 16 in the email's subject line (or else your email is highly likely to be destroyed as spam). The winning entry will be drawn at the section night meeting on Monday, 4 April 2005, and (given that April's section night speaker is French) the winner will, of course, receive a bottle of French wine.



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And here are the club trips...

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to Michele Domaneschi or Rachel Depree (trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

See you in the hills! WE NEED MORE TRIPS! COME ON GUYS

Trips for the Calendar for the rest of 2005...

Check out the proposed and planned new list for 2005. We need trip organisers to put their hands up for what are bound to be outstanding adventures. There's something for everyone in here with a mix of snow, rock and even a spot of ski touring.

Proposed...

Mt Rolleston	<i>Queens Birthday Weekend</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate – Advanced :

Organiser: Merewyn Ellis (merewyn@dialogue.co.nz)

Rolleston via Rome Ridge, Arthur's Pass.. Take a day and make it a 4 day weekend.

Mangatepopo	<i>March 2005</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock	<i>Level</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Merewyn Ellis (merewyn@dialogue.co.nz)	:



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Margaret McMahon
National Administrator
email office@alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594)



Bored at work?

Check out:

www.mojozone.co.nz
www.mountainz.co.nz





Wellington Section Directory: 2005 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Nigel Roberts	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> NR	(04) 475 7543
Vice Chairperson	Steve Hart	SH	N/A
Secretary	Garth London	SECRETARY <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Treasurer	Caroline Duggan	TREASURER <i>or</i> CD	(04) 475 5542
National Representative	Caroline Duggan	CD	(04) 475 5542
	Nigel Roberts	NR	(04) 475 7543
Instruction: AIC	Caroline Duggan	AIC	(04) 475 5542
Instruction: RIC	Scott Taylor	SPRINGROCK	N/A
Trips	Michele Domaneschi	TRIPS <i>or</i> MD	N/A
	Rachel Depree	RD	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Tom Bowen	TB	N/A
	Rachel Depree	RD	N/A
	Michele Domaneschi	MD	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PDJ	(04) 478 1017
	Alan Lowrie	AL	N/A
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National President	Dave Bamford	DB	N/A
National President Elect	Judy Reid	JR	N/A
National Vice Pres. (NI)	Nigel Roberts	NR	(04) 475 7543

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz